

Pesticide Application Checklist

When planning for pesticide applications in an IPM program, review and complete this checklist to consider practices that minimize environmental and efficacy problems.

Choose a pesticide from the UC IPM Pest Management Guidelines for the target pest, considering:

- [Impact on natural enemies and honeybees\(/agriculture/corn/relative-toxicities-of-insecticides-and-miticides-used-in-corn-to-natural-enemies-and-honey-bees/\)](#)
- Potential for water quality problems and impact on aquatic invertebrates using the [UC IPM WaterTox database\(/TOX/simplewatertox.html\)](#).
- Impact on aquatic invertebrates. For more information, see [Pesticide Choice\(http://anrcatalog.ucanr.edu/pdf/8161.pdf\)](#), UC ANR Publication 8161 (PDF).
- Chemical mode of action if pesticide resistance is an issue.

Before an application

- Choose sprayers and application procedures that keep pesticides on target.
- Identify and take special care to protect sensitive areas (for example, waterways or riparian areas) surrounding your application site.
- Review and follow label for pesticide handling, storage, and disposal guidelines. Check DPR for [chemical label updates\(http://www.cdpr.ca.gov/docs/label/labelque.htm\)](#)
- Check and follow restricted entry intervals (REI) and preharvest intervals (PHI).

After an application

- Record application date, product used, rate, and location of application.
- Follow up to confirm that treatment was effective.

Consider water management practices that reduce pesticide movement off-site.

- Install an [irrigation recirculation or storage and reuse system\(/mitigation/water_reuse.html\)](#).
- Avoid overwatering and deep percolation of water. Consider [vegetative filter strips\(/mitigation/veg_filtering.html\)](#) or ditches.
- Install sediment traps.
- Use polyacrylamide (PAM) tablets in furrows to prevent offsite movement of sediments.
- Redesign inlets and outlets into tailwater ditches to reduce erosion.

Consider practices that reduce air quality problems.

- When possible, choose pesticides that are not in emulsifiable concentrate (EC) form which release [volatile organic compounds \(VOCs\)\(/mitigation/reducing_voc.html\)](#). VOCs react with sunlight to form ozone, a major air pollutant.

For more about mitigating the effects of pesticides, see the [Mitigation page\(/mitigation/\)](#).



UC IPM Pest Management Guidelines: Corn
UC ANR Publication 3443

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Text Updated: 09/11